

the base station to allow connections only from known computers. You specify this setting by listing the MAC address of the wireless ethernet adapter in each PC.

- ▶ **DHCP:** Tell the wireless router to provide IP addresses dynamically for all computers on the network. This is also known as Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (DHCP).

Congratulations! You've now successfully set up your very own Wi-Fi router. The router remembers its settings, so there's no need to reconfigure it after a power outage. After its setup, you'll probably never need to mess with it again.

Networks on the go

So a wireless modem is only good within a certain range. But what happens when you're on the go and you want to connect your laptop or tablet to the internet. You'll be lucky if you can find a Wi-Fi hot spot – but in India, you might be hard-pressed to find one. If you're traveling by car in unfamiliar territory, for example, Wi-Fi is a not-so-convenient option. So what do you do?

This is where wireless data cards come into the picture. If you're looking for flexibility, reliability and security, there's simply no substitute for a wireless data card. It provides access anytime and anywhere to anything you need on the web from your laptop.

What's a wireless data card?

A wireless data card makes use of cellular phone technology to connect your laptop to the internet. What it does is it dials into the wireless data network of your cellular carrier, and your laptop sees this as an always-on connection. This is very similar to your DSL or cable modem at home. Access to the internet is through the network coverage of the relevant telecommunication company provider via Code Division Multiple



Wireless data card